PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, July 22, 2025

Work Session

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Work Session of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Windows Cafeteria / Conference Room (Floor 2), 501 N. Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller, Stephanie Engelsman, Virginia La Forte, Christy Splitt, and Patte Sullivan.

Student Representative Ian Ritorto: Absent

2025-2026 School Board and Superintendent Work Focus Areas

The meeting was called to order at 8:24 pm by Chair Wang.

Chair Eddie Wang opened the discussion by highlighting the focus areas identified by board members, including creating a teaching, learning, and enrollment committee and strengthening trust and communication with school communities. A draft work plan was introduced as a starting point for discussion, with the expectation that it will be revised as needed.

Superintendent Armstrong outlined her priority areas, which included progress on the Albina projects, boundary adjustments (particularly in the Jefferson cluster), strategic budget reductions, preparation and alignment in bargaining, construction transparency and cost efficiency, alignment of goals in the District Improvement Plan, and a culture of excellence in service across departments.

Board Members asked questions about the superintendent's focus areas and offered feedback on the draft work plan. Discussion topics included informational budget sessions, balancing workload with capacity, focusing on academic achievement, the distinction between board and district work and whether the Board goals should be reviewed. There was also discussion on the Board Protocols. It was noted that the Board Protocols will be revisited at the upcoming retreat. Staff will incorporate feedback into an updated draft work plan.

Adjournment

The meeting was adjourned at 9:32 pm by Board Chair Wang.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant/Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools